Parent Messaging (Room Chat & Admin chat)- Private Mode

0) Scope & Assumptions

- **Users:** Org Admins, School Admins, Teachers, Staff, Parents/Guardians.
- **Purpose:** Allow confidential communication between staff and a specific parent without other guardians seeing the message. used for seperated parents /split family
- **Platforms:** Web and Mobile.
- **Context:** Applies to messaging threads linked to a student.

User Journey

Persona: Parent
Actions:

- Login → Navigate to Messaging → Conversation thread for child opens.
- Toggle **Private Mode ON/OFF** in their chat. (if one parent turns private mode on, private mode for other parent will also be turned on & separate chats for all parents with same staff +admin+directors, & only the parent who turned it on can turn private mode off, turned off for both)
- Send messages privately to staff & admins.
- Receive private replies from staff.

Persona: Admin/Staff
Actions:

- View student's conversation → See all parent tabs.
- Identify which parent has private mode ON (icon indicator).
- Send private messages to parent in their respective tabs.

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1) UI & Flowo

Parent View

- No sidebar; conversation opens directly.
- **Private Mode Toggle** at top-right:
  - Default: OFF.
  - When ON:
    - Icon appears in parent's chat tab (visible to staff).
    - All messages sent by parent are marked as private.

    - Only staff, admins and that parent can view these messages.
- Composer supports rich text, emoji, URLs, attachments same as normal modek

Admin/Staff View

- Tabs for each parent/guardian linked to the student.
- If a parent has private mode ON:
    - Show **Private Mode icon** next to their name.
- When sending a message:
    - If typed in a specific parent tab → goes only to that parent.
    - If using **New Message** (bulk action) → goes to all parents regardless of private mode.

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2) Behavior Rules

- **Private Mode Activation:**Only the parent can turn ON/OFF private mode for their chat.
- When ON, system adds a private indicator in admin view.
- **Message Routing:**Private messages → visible only to staff and that parent.
- Bulk messages via **New Message** → sent to all parents (private mode ignored).
- **Notifications:**Private messages → notify only that parent.
- Bulk messages → notify all parents.
- **Visibility:**Other parents cannot see private messages or indicators.

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3) Field Specifications

Field Name	Data Type	Default Value	Validations	Notes
Private Mode	Boolean	OFF	N/A	Toggle in parent view only
Private Indicator	Icon	Hidden	Visible when ON	Shown in admin tabs
Message Type	Enum	Normal	Values: Normal, Private	Auto-set based on toggle

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4) Acceptance Criteria

- **AC1:** Private Mode toggle visible only in parent view.
- **AC2:** When Private Mode is ON, icon appears in admin view next to parent’s name.

- **AC3:** Messages sent in private mode are visible only to staff and that parent.
- **AC4:** Bulk messages via New Message ignore private mode and go to all parents.
- **AC5:** Notifications follow routing rules (private → one parent; bulk → all).
- **AC6:** Parent can turn private mode OFF anytime; indicator disappears immediately.
- **AC7:** Private messages show “Private” label in both parent and admin views.
- **AC8:** System prevents other parents from accessing private messages.
- **AC9:** Rich text and clickable URLs supported in private messages all emojis & attachements supported
- **AC10:** Audit logs capture private mode toggle events and message type.

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5) Gherkin Scenarios

Scenario: Activate Private Mode

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Given I am a parent viewing my child’s conversation
When I toggle Private Mode ON
Then a private indicator appears in my chat
And staff sees the icon next to my name
```

Scenario: Send Private Message

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Given Private Mode is ON
When I send ”This is confidential”
Then the message appears in the thread with a Private label
And only staff and I can view it
```

Scenario: Admin Sends Private Reply

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Given Private Mode is ON for Demo Parent
When staff types a message in Demo Parent’s tab
Then the message is marked Private
And only Demo Parent receives it
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Scenario: Bulk Message Overrides Private Mode

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Given Private Mode is ON for one parent
When staff sends a message using New Message button
Then all parents receive the message
And all are notified
```

Scenario: Deactivate Private Mode

```
Given Private Mode is ON
When I toggle it OFF
Then the private indicator disappears
And future messages are normal
```